

Word family: **private / privately / privacy / privatise / privatize / privatisation / privatization**

Base word: private

Related forms: privately, privacy, privatise/privatize, privatisation/privatization

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun in military use (軍事名詞)

Your sentence:

> “...whether **private educational activities** should be allowed to occupy commercial dining space for hours at a time.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **private** means **organized for particular individuals or paying clients rather than provided as a general public service**.

The tutorial lesson is a privately arranged activity between a tutor and students, even though it is taking place inside a restaurant open to the public.

繁體中文： **私人安排的；非公共服務性質的；由個人或私人機構為特定人士提供的**

中文翻譯：

> “...whether **private educational activities** should be allowed...”

「.....這些**私人教育 / 私人補習活動**是否應被允許.....」

Here:

private educational activities = 為特定學生安排、通常涉及私人收費或私人服務的教育活動，而不是公共空間本身提供的教育服務

1. **private = belonging to or intended for one person/group, not the public (私人) — 私人的；非公用的**

This is one of the central meanings and is closely related to your passage.

Practice 1

> “This is a **private** room.”

「這是一間**私人使用的**房間。」

Practice 2

> “The garden is **private** property.”

「這個花園屬於**私人財產**。」

Practice 3

> “Guests have access to a **private** entrance.”

「住客可以使用一個**專用 / 私人入口**。」

private = 屬於某個個人、家庭或特定群體，而不是供所有公眾自由使用的

Common:

- * private property
- * private land
- * private room
- * private entrance
- * private parking

2. **private** = provided by individuals/businesses rather than the state/public sector (私營) — 私營的；私人經營的

This is particularly relevant to:

> **private education**

Practice 4

> “She works at a **private** school.”

「她在一間**私立學校**工作。」

Practice 5

> “They chose **private** healthcare.”

「他們選擇了**私營醫療服務**。」

private = 由私人、公司或非政府機構擁有、營運或提供，而不是由政府 / 公共機構直接提供的

Common:

- * private school
- * private hospital
- * private sector
- * private healthcare
- * private enterprise

This is a major institutional sense.

3. **private = personal and not for other people to know (私事 / 隱私) — 私人的 ; 不公開的**

Private can mean relating to someone's personal life or information and not intended for public knowledge.

Practice 6

> “That is a **private** matter.”

「那是他的**私事**。」

Practice 7

> “She rarely discusses her **private** life.”

「她很少談自己的**私生活**。」

Practice 8

> “These documents contain **private** information.”

「這些文件包含**私人資料**。」

private = 屬於個人生活、資料或事情，不應由公眾或無關人士知道

Common:

- * private life
- * private matter
- * private information
- * private affairs

This is a major distinct sense.

4. **private** = confidential / not to be shared (保密) — 秘密的 ; 私下的 ; 保密的

A meeting, conversation, message, etc. can be **private** if only selected people are supposed to hear or see it.

Practice 9

> “Can we have a **private** conversation?”

「我們可以**私下談談**嗎？」

Practice 10

> “The meeting was completely **private**.”

「那場會議完全是**非公開 / 私人性質**的。」

private = 不對外公開，只限特定人士參與或知道內容的

For strict counting, this overlaps with Meaning 3, but the confidentiality aspect is useful enough to show separately.

5. **private** = secluded / free from observation or interruption (不受打擾) — 隱蔽的 ; 清靜的 ; 有私隱的

A place can be **private** when other people cannot easily see, hear, or disturb you there.

Practice 11

> “We found a **private** corner to talk.”

「我們找了一個比較**清靜、不受打擾**的**角落談話**。」

Practice 12

> “The balcony is surprisingly **private**.”

「這個露台出奇地**有私隱 / 不容易被人看見**。」

private = 不容易被外人看到、聽到或打擾，能保留個人空間的

This is distinct from mere ownership.

A place can be privately owned but not very private in this sense.

6. **private** = one-to-one / specially arranged for an individual (個別服務) — 私人 / 一對一的

A teacher, tutor, doctor, coach, lesson, etc. can be **private** when the service is arranged specifically for one person or a small group.

Practice 13

> “She takes **private** English lessons.”

「她上**私人 / 一對一英文課**。」

Practice 14

> “He hired a **private** tutor.”

「他請了一位**私人補習老師**。」

private = 為特定個人或小群體專門安排，而不是向一般公眾共同提供的

This is especially close to your passage's:

> **private educational activities**

For strict semantic counting, this can be kept under #1/#2, but it is highly relevant and should be displayed explicitly.

7. **private** = not acting in an official/public role (個人身分) — 私人身分的；非公職的

Private can contrast with someone's official, professional, or public role.

Practice 15

> “He attended the event in a **private** capacity.”

「他以**私人身分**出席活動。」

Practice 16

> “The comments were made in a **private** capacity.”

「那些言論是以**個人身分**作出的。」

****private** = 以個人而非官方 / 職務代表的身分行事******

This is an established formal use.

8. ****private** = not publicly traded/held (公司 / 金融) — 私人持有的 ; 非上市的******

In business and finance, a ****private company**** can mean a company whose shares are not publicly traded on a stock exchange.

Practice 17

> “The business remains ****privately**** owned.”

「這家公司仍然由****私人持有****。」

Practice 18

> “It is a ****private**** company rather than a publicly listed one.”

「它是一間****私人公司 / 非上市公司****，不是上市公司。」

This is an established business sense, though exact legal definitions vary by jurisdiction.

For core counting, I would keep this under Meaning 2.

9. ****private** = not open to everyone / restricted access (非公開) — 私人專用的 ; 限特定人士的******

Events, clubs, roads, beaches, networks, accounts, etc. can be ****private**** if access is restricted.

Practice 19

> “The event is ****private****.”

「這是一個****私人 / 非公開活動****。」

Practice 20

> “The account is set to ****private****.”

「這個帳戶已設定為****私人模式 / 非公開****。」

****private = 只有獲准人士才能進入、查看或參與的****

This is a highly common digital/social-media extension.

For strict counting, it belongs broadly to #1/#4.

10. ****private = intimate / relating to parts or activities normally kept hidden (私密) — 私密的****

****Private**** can refer to very personal bodily matters or intimate behaviour.

Practice 21

> “The patient was given a ****private**** area to change.”

「病人獲安排一個****私密的****地方更衣。」

This sense is especially visible in the lexicalized expression:

> ****private parts****

= ****私處 / 生殖器官****

That expression should be treated as a fixed euphemism, not another major core sense.

11. ****a private = lowest enlisted military rank (軍事名詞) — 列兵 ; 二等兵 / 士兵****

This is a completely separate noun sense.

Practice 22

> “He joined the army as a ****private****.”

「他加入軍隊時是一名****列兵 / 普通士兵****。」

Practice 23

> “The ****private**** reported to his officer.”

「那名****列兵****向軍官報到。」

****private = 某些軍隊中較低級的普通士兵軍階****

This is a genuine distinct lexical meaning.

12. **in private = away from other people / confidentially (固定表達) — 私下 ; 單獨地**

Practice 24

> “I’d like to speak to you **in private**.”

「我想和你**私下談談**。」

Practice 25

> “They discussed the issue **in private**.”

「他們**私下**討論了這個問題。」

in private = 在沒有其他人旁聽 / 觀看的情況下

This belongs to the privacy/confidentiality branch.

13. **go private = move from public/state provision or public ownership to private status (固定用法) — 轉為私營 / 私有**

Depending on context:

> a company goes private

can mean it ceases to be publicly traded.

> a service goes private

can refer more generally to moving from public/state provision into private provision.

Because the exact institutional meaning depends on context, I would store this as a construction under Meaning 2 rather than as another core sense.

Related form: **privately**

Privately has several branches.

**privately = not publicly (私下) **

Practice 26

> “They spoke **privately** after the meeting.”

「會議後他們**私下**談了一會兒。」

**privately = by private ownership/provision (私人經營) **

> “The hospital is **privately** owned.”

「這間醫院由**私人持有**。」

**privately = in one's own thoughts (內心) **

> “Privately, she doubted the plan.”

「她**心裡其實**對這個計劃有所懷疑。」

That final discourse use is especially useful:

privately = 在內心、不公開表達地

Related form: **privacy**

Privacy means the state of being free from unwanted observation, intrusion, or public exposure.

Practice 27

> “Everyone needs some **privacy**.”

「每個人都需要一些**私人空間 / 私隱**。」

Practice 28

> “The curtains provide more **privacy**.”

「窗簾能提供更多**私隱**。」

privacy = 不受別人監視、打擾或了解私人事情的狀態

This is one of the most important family words.

Related form: ****privatise / privatize****

****Privatise/privatize**** means transfer a business, service, or industry from public/state ownership or control to private ownership/control.

Practice 29

> “The service was ****privatised****.”

「這項服務被****私有化 / 轉為私營****。」

This is an institutional/economic family extension.

Related form: ****privatisation / privatization****

The noun for that process:

> ****privatisation = 私有化 / 私營化****

It should remain a family extension, not a meaning of bare ****private****.

Important distinction: ****private vs personal****

****personal****

means relating to one particular person.

****private****

adds the idea that something is:

- * not public;
- * restricted;
- * confidential;
- * personally owned.

Compare:

> personal opinion

> private conversation

A personal opinion does not need to be secret.

Important distinction: **private vs public**

This is the central contrast.

public

= open to, owned by, serving, or relating to the general population/state

private

= restricted to individuals/groups, privately owned, or not publicly accessible/known

Examples:

> public school / private school

> public space / private property

> public statement / private conversation

Important distinction: **private vs confidential**

confidential

specifically means information is intended to be kept secret.

private

is broader.

A room can be private without being confidential.

A confidential report is about information-sharing restrictions.

Important distinction: **private vs secret**

secret

means deliberately hidden and unknown to others.

private

means not intended for general public access or knowledge.

- > private life
- > secret plan

Something private is not necessarily secret.

Important distinction: **private vs secluded**

secluded

means physically away from other people.

private

means protected from observation or intrusion.

- > secluded beach
- > private room

A place can be secluded but publicly accessible.

Important distinction: **private vs individual**

individual

means relating to one person considered separately.

private

emphasizes ownership, access, confidentiality, or non-public status.

- > individual student
- > private lesson

Important distinction: **private vs independent**

****independent****

means not controlled by another person/organization.

****private****

means non-public, privately owned, personal, or restricted.

A private company may still be controlled by a parent company and therefore not independent.

Grammar note: ****private to vs private for****

Usually we say:

- > private room
- > private conversation
- > private information

For restricted availability:

- > private ****to**** members

is possible, though:

- > available only to members

is often more natural.

Countability note

****Private**** is primarily an adjective.

As a military noun:

- > a private
- > several privates

****Privacy**** is usually uncountable:

- > need privacy
- > protect privacy

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **private**
- * **privately**
- * **privacy**
- * **privatise / privatize**
- * **privatisation / privatization**

The main semantic branches are:

- * restricted ownership/use
- * non-public/private-sector provision
- * personal/confidential matters
- * seclusion/privacy
- * individually arranged service
- * private/non-official capacity
- * military noun

The family sweep also needs to recognize digital uses such as **private account/message**, which remain part of the restricted-access branch rather than becoming a separate technological sense.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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private — ownership/access	屬於個人或特定群體，而不是公眾共同使用 / 擁有的
private — sector/institution	由私人或公司擁有、營運或提供，而非政府 / 公共機構提供的
private — personal life/information	屬於個人、不打算讓公眾或無關人士知道的
private — confidential meeting/conversation	只限特定人士參與或知道內容的；非公開的
private — secluded	不容易被外人看見、聽見或打擾，有私隱的
private — lesson/service	為特定個人 / 小群體專門安排的一對一或私人服務
private — capacity	以個人而非官方、公職或代表身分行事的
private — company	私人持有 / 非公開上市；具體法律定義依司法地區
private — restricted digital access	只有獲准人士可以查看 / 進入的
a private — military	軍隊中的低階普通士兵 / 列兵

in private	私下、單獨、不讓其他人旁聽 / 觀看	
privacy	不受外界監視、打擾或侵犯私人空間的狀態	
privatise	把原本公共 / 政府擁有或營運的事物轉為私營 / 私有	

For your original sentence

> “...whether ****private educational activities**** should be allowed to occupy commercial dining space...”

The exact meaning is:

****private = 由個人 / 私人補習者為特定學生安排，而不是餐廳或公共機構向一般公眾提供的教育活動****

So:

> ****private educational activities****

= ****私人補習 / 私人安排的教育活動****

The contrast is central to the editorial:

> a ****private**** activity is occupying a space that functions as a ****shared commercial/publicly accessible**** dining area.

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****private****:

1. ****belonging to/restricted to an individual or particular group****
2. ****privately owned/provided rather than public/state-run****
3. ****personal/confidential; not for public knowledge****
4. ****secluded/protected from observation or interruption****
5. ****individually arranged service — private lesson/tutor/doctor****
6. ****noun: low-ranking soldier****

I would merge ****private capacity, private account, private event, private company**** into the relevant broader branches, while keeping ****privacy / privately / privatise / privatisation**** as family extensions rather than artificially increasing the adjective count.